in order to meet the overwhelming challenge posed by Political Realists.

However, the impact of feminist engagement on politics and on public policies across the world cannot be denied. That several conventions recognize women's rights itself is a positive development. Untiring efforts of the feminist have raised consciousness about gender issues. Feminists and international lawyers have been successful in getting rape classified, for the first time, as a war crime, and categorized by the international tribunals on former Yugoslavia and Rwanda as a form of torture. Sexual discrimination and maltreatment has been accepted by some countries like Canada and Spain as grounds for political asylum. International non-governmental organizations and also aid agencies involved in providing assistance to the developing countries have specified in their development policy in general gender concerns as the centre of their donation policies. Even participation of women in political decision-making has been made possible through reservation of seats for women, as in India, in the case of local self-governmental institutions (a national bill is still pending). In practice, however, a lot has to be done to increase the level of gender sensitivity in IR.